

PROJECT REPORT

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Workflow Automation Project

Team ID	SWTID-2026-9023
Team Size	4
Team Leader	BOUSHIYA C
Team Member	ASIN K
Team Member	Deepika T
Team Member	FLORAMERCY K

Platform: ServiceNow

Primary Automation Tool: Flow Designer

1. Project Overview

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer is a ServiceNow-based project designed to simplify and automate the process of requesting standard laptops for employees.

In a traditional IT procurement process, employees may need to contact the IT department manually, submit requests through emails or forms, wait for approvals, and track the status of their requests. This can result in delays, repetitive administrative work, and difficulty in tracking requests.

The proposed solution uses ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer to provide a structured process for submitting, approving, processing, and tracking standard laptop requests.

2. Problem Statement

IT departments regularly receive requests for laptops and other hardware. A manual process can create delays, inconsistent handling, repetitive administrative work, and limited visibility into request status.

- Employees may submit requests through different channels.
- IT teams need to manually review requests.
- Approval processes may take longer.
- Requests can be difficult to track.
- IT staff may perform repetitive tasks.
- Employees may not receive timely status updates.

Therefore, an automated system is proposed to provide a standardized and trackable laptop ordering process.

3. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution combines ServiceNow Service Catalog and Flow Designer. A user submits a standard laptop request through a Catalog Item. Flow Designer then controls the subsequent steps, such as validation, approval, task creation, notifications, and status updates.

Employee → Laptop Request → Flow Designer → Validate → Approval → IT/Procurement Task → Notifications → Processing → Completion

4. Objectives

- Automate the standard laptop ordering process.
- Provide employees with an easy request form.
- Reduce manual IT procurement activities.
- Introduce a structured approval process.
- Automatically create tasks for the responsible IT team.
- Send notifications regarding request progress.
- Improve request tracking and visibility.
- Reduce processing effort for standard laptop requests.
- Provide a consistent procurement workflow.
- Demonstrate practical use of ServiceNow Flow Designer.

5. Technologies Used

Technology	Purpose
ServiceNow	IT service management platform
Flow Designer	Automation and workflow processing
Service Catalog	Laptop request submission
Catalog Item	Standard laptop request form
Catalog Variables	Collect employee and laptop information
Approvals	Manage authorization of requests
Notifications	Inform users and IT teams
ServiceNow Records/Tables	Store and track request information

6. Main Features

6.1 Standard Laptop Request

The employee can submit a request using a ServiceNow Catalog Item. The form can collect employee details, department, laptop type, required date, business justification, and other requirements.

6.2 Automated Flow

After submission, Flow Designer automatically starts the predefined process instead of requiring every step to be handled manually.

6.3 Approval Process

The request can be routed to an appropriate manager or authorized approver. The next step depends on the approval result.

6.4 Task Creation

After approval, a task can be created for the appropriate IT or procurement team.

6.5 Notifications

Automated notifications can inform employees, approvers, and IT staff about important request events.

6.6 Request Tracking

The requester and responsible teams can track the request through its lifecycle.

7. Flow Designer Workflow

EMPLOYEE SUBMITS REQUEST ↓ FLOW IS TRIGGERED ↓ VALIDATE REQUEST ↓ REQUEST APPROVAL ↓ APPROVED?
 → NO: REJECT/CLOSE REQUEST ↓ YES CREATE IT/PROCUREMENT TASK ↓ NOTIFY IT TEAM / REQUESTER ↓
 PROCESS ORDER ↓ COMPLETE REQUEST

8. Implementation Steps

Step 1: Create the Service Catalog Item

Create a catalog item named Standard Laptop Request.

Step 2: Create Catalog Variables

Collect required employee, laptop, department, date, manager, and justification information.

Step 3: Create the Flow

Create a Flow Designer flow such as Standard Laptop Procurement Automation and define the trigger.

Step 4: Add Conditions

Validate that required information is available before continuing.

Step 5: Add Approval

Configure approval for the appropriate manager or authorized person.

Step 6: Process Approval Result

Continue processing for an approved request or update/reject the request when approval is denied.

Step 7: Create Procurement Task

Create an IT/procurement task containing relevant request details.

Step 8: Configure Notifications

Notify the employee, approver, and IT team at appropriate workflow stages.

9. Example Scenario

An employee needs a standard laptop. The employee opens the Service Catalog, selects Standard Laptop Request, enters the required details, and submits the request. Flow Designer starts the workflow, routes the request for approval, and—if approved—creates an IT/procurement task. Notifications keep the requester and responsible team informed until the request is completed.

10. Testing

Test Case	Expected Result
Valid laptop request	Request should be created.
Incomplete request	Missing information should be identified.
Manager approves	Procurement process should continue.
Manager rejects	Request should be rejected/closed.
Approved request	IT/procurement task should be created.
Status changes	Appropriate notification should be generated.
Procurement completed	Request should reach completed state.

11. Expected Benefits

- Faster and more structured request processing.
- Reduced manual work for IT staff.
- Better request tracking and visibility.
- Consistent handling of standard laptop requests.

- Improved communication through automated notifications.
- Reduced risk of manual data-entry and coordination errors.

12. Before and After Automation

Before Automation

Employee → Email/Manual Request → IT Review → Manual Approval → Manual Task Creation → Manual Communication → Procurement

After Automation

Employee → Service Catalog → Flow Designer → Approval → Automatic Task Creation → Automatic Notifications → Procurement → Completion

13. Team Contributions

Member	Suggested Contribution
BOUSHIYA C	Project coordination, requirement analysis, flow design, team management, documentation
ASIN K	Service Catalog configuration, catalog item design, request form preparation, testing
Deepika T	Flow Designer configuration, approval workflow, notification setup, testing
FLORAMERCY K	Documentation, test case preparation, project presentation, GitHub organization

Note: Adjust these contribution descriptions if the actual work was divided differently.

14. Future Enhancements

- Automatic inventory checking.
- Integration with hardware asset management.
- Automatic laptop assignment.
- Procurement vendor integration.
- Email and mobile notifications.
- SLA monitoring.
- Dashboard for IT administrators.
- Approval escalation for delayed approvals.
- Automated asset record creation.
- Integration with employee onboarding workflows.

15. Conclusion

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer demonstrates how ServiceNow automation can organize and simplify a common IT procurement process.

By combining Service Catalog, Flow Designer, approvals, tasks, and notifications, the proposed solution creates a structured workflow for handling standard laptop requests. The project aims to reduce manual effort, improve visibility, standardize the procurement process, and provide a better experience for employees and IT teams.

16. Project Information

Project Title	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9023
Team Size	4
Team Leader	BOUSHIYA C
Team Members	ASIN K; Deepika T; FLORAMERCY K
Platform	ServiceNow
Primary Tool	Flow Designer
Project Type	IT Service Management / Workflow Automation

17. Suggested GitHub Repository Structure

SWTID-2026-9023/ ■■■■ README.md ■■■■ Documentation/ ■ ■■■■ Project_Report.pdf ■ ■■■■
 Project_Overview.md ■ ■■■■ Testing_Documentation.md ■■■■ Screenshots/ ■ ■■■■
 Service_Catalog.png ■ ■■■■ Flow_Designer.png ■ ■■■■ Approval.png ■ ■■■■ IT_Task.png ■ ■■■■
 Notifications.png ■■■■ Presentation/ ■■■■ Project_Presentation.pptx

Documentation Note: Any sections marked as proposed, expected, or example should be updated to match the team's actual ServiceNow implementation before final submission.